CHOCOLATE FRIANDS

MAKES	ACTIVE TIME	REST	TOTAL TIME
24 mini cakes	**30 min**	**1 h for the ganache to set**	**about 2 h**

OVEN
350F for 12-15 min

INGREDIENTS

170 g	Bittersweet chocolate, coarsely chopped, for the batter
225 g	Unsalted butter
4	Eggs, large
265 g	Sugar
100 g	All-purpose flour, sifted
2 tbsp	Cornstarch
1/4 tsp	Salt
115 g	Bittersweet chocolate, chopped, for the ganache
150 ml	Heavy cream, for the ganache

METHOD

1. Heat the oven to 350F. Set out 24 paper liners for mini-muffin cups on a baking sheet. The alternative is 24 buttered and floured wells of a mini-muffin tin, with the loose flour knocked out.
2. Put the chopped chocolate for the batter in a large mixing bowl.
3. Melt the butter in a small saucepan over medium heat and take it to very hot. Pour it over the chocolate and whisk until the mixture is smooth.
4. Whisk in the eggs one at a time, each one disappearing before the next goes in.
5. In a medium bowl, whisk the sugar, flour, cornstarch and salt together.
6. Tip the chocolate mixture onto the dry ingredients and whisk thoroughly.
7. Pour the batter into a liquid measuring cup, which makes it easy to handle, and fill the cups almost to their rims.
8. Bake 12 to 15 minutes, until the tops have only just begun to crack.
9. Rest them 10 minutes on a wire rack. Turn them out of the tin if you used one and let them cool completely. Cakes baked in paper cups stay in their cups.
10. Weigh the ganache chocolate into a bowl that will take heat. Separately, bring the cream to the very edge of a boil over a medium flame.
11. Pour it over the chocolate and leave the two alone for a minute or two, then stir it gently with a rubber spatula until the mixture is melted and glossy.
12. Take each friand by the sides, turn it top-down into the ganache, then shake it lightly so the surplus runs back off. Set it on the rack again.
13. Leave the ganache to set somewhere cool for about an hour.

NOTES

Use a bitter chocolate at 70 percent cacao or higher.
The melted butter has to be genuinely hot when it meets the chopped chocolate, because that is the only heat the chocolate gets.
Bake time swings on how full the cups are, which is why the window runs from 12 to 15 minutes. Tops that have just started to crack is the cue.
Glassine cups of 4 cm by 12 mm are the right size for baking and serving, or cut paper cupcake liners down. Fill them with a piping bag or a tiny ice-cream scoop.
Setting the ganache in the refrigerator in a hot kitchen beads condensation on the tops. Box them airtight first, chill them, then let them come back to room temperature in the box. Airtight in the refrigerator they keep 5 days.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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